PJDSC 2026

Trace the Pattern, Target the Cure

Advancing Public Health Through Data Science

EVENT PRIMER

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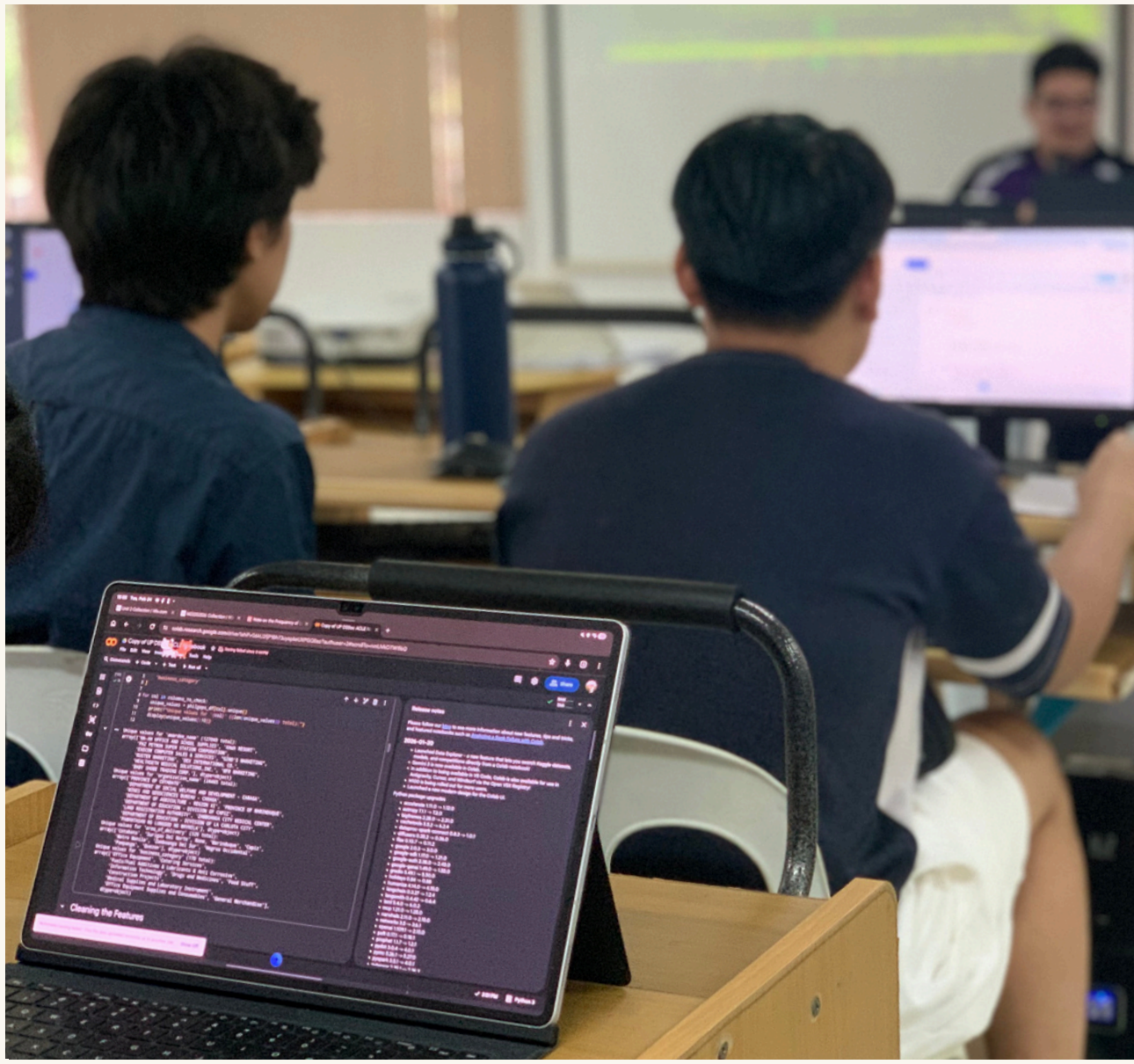
ABOUT PJDSC 2026

PJDSC 2025 Final Round

The Philippine Junior Data Science Challenge (PJDSC) 2026, organized by the UP Data Science Society (UP DSSoc), is a nationwide data science event open to all interested students currently in senior high school or university.

PJDSC 2026 consists of talks, workshops, an initial proposal submission, and a data science project, all of which aim to provide an avenue for students to learn, apply, and develop data skills in a competitive setting.



WHAT IS DATA SCIENCE?

Data science is a multidisciplinary field that combines statistics, mathematics, and computer science to extract meaningful insights from data. It involves collecting, analyzing, and interpreting large volumes of data to uncover patterns, make predictions, and inform decision-making.

Data scientists use various tools and techniques, including machine learning algorithms and data visualization, to turn raw data into actionable insights. By applying these methods, they help organizations solve complex problems, optimize processes, and drive innovation.

In this competition, participants will be formulating a project that demonstrates how data science can be applied to address real-world challenges in public health analytics.

THIS YEAR'S PJDSC
FOCUSES ON

PUBLIC HEALTH ANALYTICS

> "Trace the Pattern, Target the Cure: Advancing Public Health Through Data Science"

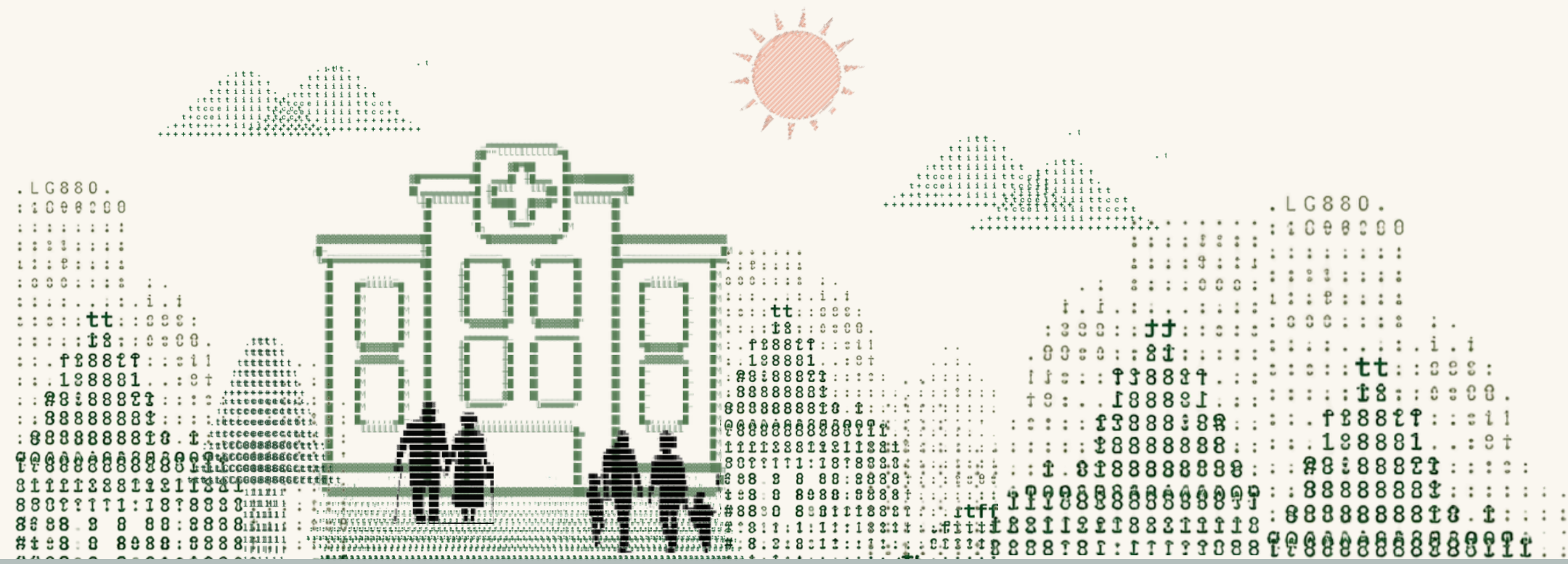
THIS YEAR'S CHALLENGE

Building a Healthier Tomorrow Through Data-Driven Solutions

Communities across the Philippines face complex public health challenges that require timely, effective, and accessible solutions. From monitoring disease outbreaks and predicting health risks to improving healthcare delivery and resource distribution, data plays an increasingly important role in shaping public health decisions.

However, transforming diverse health datasets into meaningful insights and actionable strategies remains a challenge.

How can data analytics and innovative approaches be leveraged to develop practical solutions that improve disease prevention, support early intervention, strengthen healthcare systems, and promote healthier communities?



EVENT MECHANICS

GUIDE TO PARTICIPATING IN PJDSC 2026

01 ELIGIBILITY

- Open to **teams of 3-5 members** of senior high school students or tertiary students from a school or university in the Philippines. The members **need not be** from the same university or school.
- A demographic quota (National Capital Region, Luzon, Visayas, Mindanao; **5 per region**) will be implemented for the early registration. An open demographic, first-come, first-served basis will be open for the Regular Registration Period.
  - Teams may choose to represent a region on the condition that: (1) at least one of the team members is from the chosen region, (2) the university that at least one of the team members is from the chosen region.
  - Quota slots may be forfeited by the organizers if found ineligible for the chosen region for the purpose of bypassing the regional requirements.
- Members of the UP Data Science Society may also compete as long as they are not Executive Board (EB) members, Vice-Directors (VD), or PJDSC 2026 managing members of the organization.

02 REGISTRATION

- Registration is on a **first-come, first-served** basis, limited to a total of **40 teams**
- Interested teams must register and pay the corresponding fee **per member** on or before the deadlines shown below.

REGISTRATION FEE:

Early Registration: Php 300
Regular Registration: Php 350

A strict no refund policy shall be enforced.

DEADLINES:

Early Registration: Sept. 25
Regular Registration: Sept. 30

Time is **11:59PM** for both dates.

EVENT MECHANICS

GUIDE TO PARTICIPATING IN PJDSC 2026

02 REGISTRATION

CONTINUATION

Registration Schema

2026

Early Registration, September 21-25

Form Submitted
During Early Registration Period (Sept. 21-25)

First 5 of the region to register?

yes → **Pay Registration Fee**
50php Discount pax

No, redirect to regular

Regular Registration, September 28-30

Form Submitted
During Registration Period (Sept. 28-30)

Slots Available?

yes → **Pay Registration Fee**

Official PJDSC Participating Team

no → ***Slots full, wait for last call***

Note. A payment form will be sent to the email addresses of qualified teams. Your slot will only be secured once payment is received. Please complete your payment before the deadline, or your slot will be forfeited. Registration fees are non-refundable.

EVENT MECHANICS

GUIDE TO PARTICIPATING IN PJDSC 2026

02 REGISTRATION

CONTINUATION

SCAN/CLICK THE QR CODES BELOW TO ACCESS THE REGISTRATION FORMS

EARLY REGISTRATION FORM

bit.ly/PJDSC2026EarlyRegForm

REGULAR REGISTRATION FORM

bit.ly/PJDSC2026RegularRegForm

Make sure the names of each member are typed correctly.
The names in the submitted form will be the basis in releasing the certificates.

EVENT FLOW

HOW THE CHALLENGE UNFOLDS

01 CONCEPT PROPOSAL SUBMISSION

Teams submit a concept proposal based on the competition theme.

- Each team must submit a **PDF** of their initial concept proposal
- Written proposals are limited to **5 pages only**, including references and appendices. The title page is excluded. Teams should ensure their outputs include the background, problem statement, objectives, scope, and methodology of their proposal.
- The proposal template can be accessed through this link: **https://bit.ly/pjdsc2026pptemplate**

GET TEMPLATE

- Topics from the theme include, but are not limited to, the following:
  - Disease Surveillance and Outbreak Monitoring, Disease Risk Prediction and Early Detection, Epidemiological Modeling and Transmission Analysis, Healthcare Resource Planning and Optimization, Healthcare Access and Service Delivery, Community Health Assessment and Intervention, Environmental Health and Risk Analysis, Health Behavior and Population Trends, Digital Health Systems and Applications, and Public Health Communication and Decision Support.
- Concept proposals should include the identification of **at least one problem** in the field of public health analytics and **at least one proposed solution or method of mitigating and addressing** any of the identified problems.
- Solutions may be in the form of a web application, mobile app, dashboard, or any usable product.

EVENT FLOW

HOW THE CHALLENGE UNFOLDS

01 CONCEPT PROPOSAL SUBMISSION

CONTINUATION

- To be eligible for the final project submission round, each team **must submit a complete initial proposal** containing all required components **AND** have **at least one representative attend the official event launch**. Only teams that meet both requirements will be allowed to participate in the workshops and collaboration sessions.
- Submissions for the initial concept proposal will open at the official event launch on **10 October 2026, 12:00 AM**, and will close on **12 October 2026, 11:59 PM**. Teams may begin preparing their proposals in advance and submit them through this link once available: **bit.ly/pjdsc2026ConceptProposalSubmission**

SUBMIT PROPOSAL

02 PROJECT DEVELOPMENT STAGE

Teams submit a concept proposal based on the competition theme.

- After the initial proposal submission, teams will enter the **development phase**, during which they are expected to refine their project through curated workshops and talks.
- Each final proposal must include an updated slide deck (PDF), a recorded project demonstration video, and a link to the complete code repository.
- Slide decks are strictly limited to a **maximum of 20 slides**, including the title slide, references, and appendices. The recorded video presentation must not exceed **3 minutes in length**. Exceeding either limit will **incur a deduction** based on the extent of non-compliance: 1 point for every 1–2 slides beyond the 20-slide limit, and 1 point for every 15 seconds beyond the 3-minute limit, up to a maximum of 10 points per requirement.

EVENT FLOW

HOW THE CHALLENGE UNFOLDS

02 PROJECT DEVELOPMENT STAGE

CONTINUATION

- Final projects must be submitted on or before **October 24, 2026, 11:59 PM** through this link once available: **bit.ly/pjdsc2026FinalProjectSubmission**

SUBMIT PROJECT

- The projects must include and will be judged with the following criteria:
  - **Project Rationale and Design** - Problem Statement and Motivation; Data Sources and Acquisition; Methodology and Approach
  - **Execution and Impact** - Findings and Analysis; Challenges and Mitigation Strategies; Future Directions and Real-World Application
  - **Code Repository** – Code Structure and Documentation; Functional Execution and Reproducibility; Dependencies and Data Management
  - **Demonstration Video** - Communication Quality and Clarity; Technical Content and Functional Showcase; Enhancement of Audience Comprehension
  - **Technical Rigor and Innovation** – Validity and Appropriateness of Techniques; Novelty and Creativity; Analytical Depth
  - **Sources** - reliable, up-to-date, APA 7th Edition.
- The **Top 10 teams** will be selected based on the above criteria and will be announced on **November 4, 2026**, via PJDSC's official social media channels and direct email notification.

EVENT FLOW

HOW THE CHALLENGE UNFOLDS

03 EVENT CULMINATION

A. Advanced Workshops

- A series of online workshops will be conducted on **November 7, 2026,** primarily designed for the Top 10 teams advancing to the final round.
- The workshop will cover key data science concepts and techniques relevant to the development and refinement of the finalists' projects.
- Each finalist team will be assigned a mentor for a dedicated mentorship session afterward to provide tailored guidance and support.
- Non-qualifying teams are welcome to attend the workshop, but will not be eligible to participate in the mentorship sessions.

B. Final Round

- Finalist teams will present their final working project or product through a live, interactive demonstration of their prototype or solution on **November 14, 2026, in Quezon City.**
- Each team is required to deliver a **stage presentation lasting 10 minutes**, followed by a **10-minute Q&A segment** with the panel of judges. The presentation time limit will be *strictly enforced*. Teams that reach the 10-minute limit will be immediately stopped, and no additional presentation time will be permitted.

EVENT FLOW

HOW THE CHALLENGE UNFOLDS

03 EVENT CULMINATION

B. Final Round

CONTINUATION

- The Finalist Teams will be judged with the following criteria:
  - **Demonstrated Functionality & Technical Robustness** -Technical Execution and Performance; Code Quality and Reproducibility
  - **Impact and Real-World Applicability** - Tangible Impact; Scalability and Deployment; Sustainability
  - **User Experience & Design** - Accessibility and Intuitiveness; Interaction Design; Output Clarity and Insight Communication
  - **Presentation & Communication** - Presentation Quality and Engagement; Q&A Competence
  - **Sources** - reliable, up-to-date, APA 7th Edition.
- Each team shall be assigned a dedicated demonstration station in addition to their onstage presentation. The demonstration station is provided for exhibit and viewing purposes only and will not be included in the official evaluation or scoring of the competition.

EVENT FLOW

HOW THE CHALLENGE UNFOLDS

03 EVENT CULMINATION

B. Final Round

CONTINUATION

- The project in its entirety, including the code and datasets, will be featured on the UP Data Science Society's official GitHub page with proper citation given to each contributing team member. Selected project outputs may also be featured on the organization's official social media platforms for promotional and informational purposes. By participating in the competition, teams acknowledge and consent to the publication of their submitted works on these platforms.

We at UP Data Science believe that sharing your work with the public is crucial for driving progress and innovation. By making your insights accessible, you not only enhance your impact and visibility but also inspire collaboration and contribute to the broader community. Together, we can achieve more by sharing our knowledge.

EVENT FLOW

HOW THE CHALLENGE UNFOLDS

04 AWARDING

- All individual participants shall be given certificates of participation, and the top 10 teams that qualify for the final round shall be given certificates of recognition.
- The **top three teams** at the end of the final round shall be awarded cash prizes.

EVENT TIMELINE

01
Early Registration Period
21 September 2026 - 25 September 2026

02
Regular Registration Period
28 September 2026 - 30 September 2026

03
Event Launch
10 October 2026

04
Proposal Submission Deadline
12 October 2026

05
Project Development Workshop
17 October 2026

06
Final Project Submission Deadline
24 October 2026

07
Announcement of Finalists
04 November 2026

08
Advanced Workshop
07 November 2026

09
Event Culmination
14 November 2026

Note: Exact days may be subject to change

FAQ

1. I am not from Computer Science, Statistics, Engineering, or any degree program directly related to Data Science. Am I still allowed to register?

The competition is open to all undergraduates from any university with no restrictions on degree programs.

2. I'm an undergraduate but currently on LOA, can I still participate?

Yes, you may still participate if you are an undergraduate who is currently on Leave of Absence.

3. Do I need to have any programming experience to join the competition?

It is not a requirement, but it would help. We will hold a workshop with learning sessions to be able to widen your knowledge in data science but most of the programming aspect is left for you to learn.

4. What programming language are we allowed to use?

You are allowed to use anything as long as you are able to successfully formulate your proposed data science solutions.

5. Can our team have members from different universities and regions?

Yes. You are free to team up with members from all over the Philippines as long as they meet the criteria for joining.

6. Where will the Hybrid/Face-to-face events take place?

The venue for the hybrid/face-to-face events will be in Metro Manila, with the exact location to be determined. Updates will be announced on the Philippine Junior Data Science Challenge Facebook page.

7. What if one of our team members drops out during the event?

It is okay as long as you still have at least 3 members. However, if you do not meet the minimum number of members, you will need to find a replacement member.

8. Can non-finalist participants attend the final round or culminating event?

Depending on the attendance limit of the culminating event, non-finalist participants are welcome to attend the final culminating event as visitors. They may explore the booths of finalist teams, as well as those of event sponsors and partners for networking and engagement opportunities.

ABOUT THE ORGANIZER

Founded in 2020, UP Data Science Society (UP DSSoc) is the first data science organization at the University of the Philippines (UP).

The organization aims to provide an environment for aspiring data scientists to engage in insightful data science discussions and to hone their skills, regardless of skill level, through workshops and other opportunities.

UP DSSoc also envisions itself as a multidisciplinary organization that equips and empowers members to use data science to produce data-driven solutions for social good, aligning both internal and external events to contribute to the advancement of communities at large.

The work and activities held in UP DSSoc revolve around the organization's core values of Purposeful Learning, Community for Innovation, and Utak at Puso.

OUR VISION

A multidisciplinary organization whose members contribute to society through innovative solutions to community problems using Data Science, and help responsibly develop the field of Data Science in the country.

OUR MISSION

To provide an avenue for Data Science enthusiasts of UP Diliman to safely share ideas and experiences, hone their skills, and collaborate to build socially relevant and impactful projects while promoting data science and its real-life applications.

Organized by

UP DATA SCIENCE SOCIETY

Powered by Data Driven People

Connect with us

UP Data Science Society
facebook.com/updatasciencesociety

Philippine Junior Data Science Challenge
facebook.com/pjdsc.updssoc

For event concerns
updatasciencesociety@gmail.com

UP Data Science Society
linkedin.com/company/updatasciencesociety